CouriersPlease

# Domestic Quote

API Documentation

# Version Control

| Version | Date | Notes | Author |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1.0.0** | 15/06/2016 | Initial version. | Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease) |
| **1.0.1** | 7/07/2016 | Suburb and postcode validation | Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease) |
| **1.0.2** | 26/10/2016 | Fixed URLs. | Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease) |
| **1.0.3** | 21/02/2017 | Updated satchel information. | Jeff Embro (CouriersPlease) |
| **1.0.4** | 11/12/2018 | Physical and volume weight restriction changes | Kalpesh Pandya (CouriersPlease) |
| 1.0.5 | 25/02/2025 | Update API Response and examples | Silvio Mueller (CouriersPlease) |

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# Overview

This document defines the API in which E-Merchants can obtain a list of eligible rates for a consignment based on the customer's rate card. The rate card information returned from this API is to be used to when using the Domestic Shipment Create API.

Please note, in relation to Satchels, the Domestic Quote API does not determine if an item can physically fit into a Satchel. Though the Satchels are designed to accommodate items up to a specific weight and volume the item's dimensions and physical attributes may render it unsuitable to be placed into a Satchel.

# Format

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Request** | JSON | |
| **Response** | JSON | XML Response Discontinued 2024 |
| **HTTP Method** | POST | |
| **Authorization** | BASIC | Combination of account number and API Key |

# URLs

## Sandbox

While developing and testing use the sandbox URL:

https://api-test.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/quote

## Production

After deploying to live use the production URL:

https://api.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/quote

# Security

## API Access

API security is controlled by CouriersPlease. CouriersPlease controls the following:

1. Access to Sandbox environment.
2. Access to Production environment.
3. Access to each individual API.
4. Hourly/Daily/Monthly limits.

If you require security changes then please contact CouriersPlease API support:

Email apisupport@couriersplease.com.au or connect@couriersplease.com.au

## Authentication

API Validation is performed through HTTP Basic Authentication using the CouriersPlease Account Number and Authorization Token.

Username: CouriersPlease Account Number

Password: Sandbox or Production Token provided from the CouriersPlease API Developer Portal

When using HTTP Basic Authentication, the Username and Password must be Base64 encoded in the header.

If your CouriersPlease Account Number is W99999 and your token is ABC123456789 your Authentication Header would be “Authorization: Basic W99999:ABC123456789” before encoding it. Once encoded, it should look as follows: “Authorization: Basic Vzk5OTk5OkFCQzEyMzQ1Njc4OQ==”

## Encryption

The API Endpoints and Portal are encrypted using SSL as follows:

| SSL Attribute | SSL Detail |
|---|---|
| **Signature Hash Algorithm** | sha256 |
| **Public Key** | RSA (2048 Bits) |

# API Request

This section contains the parameters and examples of a Domestic Quote API request

## Parameters

| Name | Type | Content |
|---|---|---|
| **fromSuburb (Required)** | String | Valid Australian suburb |
| **fromPostcode (Required)** | String | Valid Australian postcode e.g.) 2000, 0800 |
| **toSuburb (Required)** | String | Valid Australian suburb |
| **toPostcode (Required)** | String | Valid Australian postcode e.g.) 2000, 0800 |
| **items (Required)** | Object | At least one item object is required |
| **quantity (Required)** | Integer | 1 to 10. Maximum 10 items |
| **length (Required)** | Integer | Whole number in CM. Range 1-180 (see note 1) |
| **width (Required)** | Integer | Whole number in CM. Range 1-180 (see note 1) |
| **height (Required)** | Integer | Whole number in CM. Range 1-180 (see note 1) |
| **physicalWeight (Required)** | Decimal | 2 decimal places in Kilograms. Range 0.01 to 25.00 |

**Note 1**: There is an oversize surcharge for dimensions exceeding 105cm. Maximum volume per item is 0.16 cubic meters.

## Sample Request HTTP

Below is a sample request that returns JSON. The HTTP Request Header must contain application (example: “Accept: application/json”). The username and password are Base64 encoded in the authorization header as specified in the Authentication section of this document.

### Request

POST https://api-test.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/quote HTTP/1.1

### Request Header

Host: api-test.couriersplease.com.au Accept: application/json
Content-Type: application/json
Authorization: Basic Vzk5OTk5OkFCQzEyMzQ1Njc4OQ== Content-Length: 462

## Request Body (1 item)

```
{
  "fromSuburb": "Manly",
  "fromPostcode": 2095,
  "toSuburb": "Ball Bay",
  "toPostcode": 4741,
  "items": [
    {
      "quantity": "1",
      "length": "24",
      "width": "10",
      "height": "55",
      "physicalWeight": "12"
    }
  ]
}
```

## Request Body (multiple items)

```
{
  "fromSuburb": "Manly",
  "fromPostcode": 2095,
  "toSuburb": "Ball Bay",
  "toPostcode": 4741,
  "items": [
    {
      "quantity": "1",
      "length": "24",
      "width": "10",
      "height": "55",
      "physicalWeight": "12"
    },
    {
      "quantity": "2",
      "length": "18",
      "width": "12",
      "height": "40",
      "physicalWeight": "23"
     }
  ]
}
```

(Note: where quantity is more than 1 then the API assumes multiple items of the same weight and size. In the above example each of the 2 item weights 23Kg and has dimensions of 18cm, 12cm and 40cm)

## Sample request using CURL

```
curl \
--location 'https://api-test.couriersplease.com.au/v1/domestic/quote' \
--header 'Content-Type: application/json' \
--header 'Authorization: Basic Vzk5OTk5OkFCQzEyMzQ1Njc4OQ==' \
--data '{
  "fromSuburb": "Manly",
  "fromPostcode": 2095,
  "toSuburb": "Ball Bay",
  "toPostcode": 4741,
  "items": [
    {
      "quantity": "1",
      "length": "24",
      "width": "10",
      "height": "55",
      "physicalWeight": "12"
    }
  ]
}'
```

# API Response

Each request will return both an HTTP Status Code and a Response Code, which can be used to understand if the request was successfully processed. The response code will be in JSON.

## API Response Codes

| Code | Response |
|---|---|
| 200 | Success |
| 401 | Authentication failed |
| 403 | Requesting server IP address is blocked |
| 404 | No data found |
| 429 | Number of allowable requests exceeded |
| 500 | Error in process or service unavailable |

Note. If a request is successful, but no results are returned, then check the following:

1. Suburbs are spelled correctly and assigned the correct postcode. Use the Locations API to validate suburbs and postcodes.
2. Check that the account has available rates for the origin and destination suburb.

Check the trouble shooting guide at the end of this document for more information.

## API Response Object

A successful API response, where HTTPS Status Code = 200 and Response Code = SUCCESS, will return an object with field names as follows:

| Field Name | Description |
|---|---|
| **CalculatedFreightCharge** | Freight charge excluding fuel levies and GST<br>Total charge = CalculatedFreightCharge + CalculatedFuelCharge + GST |
| **CalculatedFuelCharge** | calculated standard fuel levy.<br>EOFC will be included in this calculation mid 2025 |
| **ETA** | Estimated time of arrival in business days |
| **PickupCutOffTime** | Latest time a pickup will occur. Usually 3:59PM |
| **RateCardCode** | Name of Rate Card. This code will be the rateCardId used in the Shipment Create API |
| **RateCardDescription** | Description of Rate Card |
| **Weight** | Total chargeable weight of item(s). See notes on calculating Chargeable Weight |

## API Response Exclusions

The following charges are not included in the API response.

| Surcharge Name | Value | Description |
|---|---|---|
| **GST** | 10% | GST is not included in the API response |
| **EOFC** | Variable percentage, updated monthly. | Extra Ordinary Fuel Surcharge. This is an additional fuel levy that applies to all services. It should be applied to the total cost of the freight, including the standard fuel levy, before GST is applied. |
| **Length Surcharge** | Fixed. Updated annually. | Applies if any dimension of a parcel exceeds 105cm |
| **Regional Surcharge** | Fixed. Updated annually. | Applies to regional areas where agents apply additional delivery fees. |

## Sample Response (200 - Success)


```
{
  "responseCode": "SUCCESS",
  "msg": "",
  "data": [
    {
      "CalculatedFreightCharge": "54.52",
      "CalculatedFuelCharge": "15.70",
      "ETA": "6 - 8 Business Days",
      "PickupCutOffTime": "15:59",
      "RateCardCode": "L55",
      "RateCardDescription": "Road express",
      "Weight": "12.00"
    },
    {
      "CalculatedFreightCharge": "45.01",
      "CalculatedFuelCharge": "0.00",
      "ETA": "6 - 8 Business Days",
      "PickupCutOffTime": "15:59",
      "RateCardCode": "TDKG",
      "RateCardDescription": "Road express",
      "Weight": "12.00"
    }
  ]
}
```


(Note: The API found two rate cards that were valid for the request, so, it returned both in the response).

## Sample Response (404 – Not Found))


```
{
  "responseCode": "404",
  "msg": "Data not found",
  "data": null
}
```


(Note: An invalid suburb pass passed in the request and no rate card was found for that suburb)

## Sample Response (401 - Unauthorized)


```
{
"responseCode": "UNAUTHORIZED",
"msg": "Not a valid token.",
"data": ""
}
```


(Note: An invalid API key was used)

## Sample Response (400 – Bad Request)


```
{
  "responseCode": "INVALID_INPUT",
  "msg": "Data Validation Errors.",
  "data": {
    "errors": [
      {
        "type": "Required Field",
        "field": "FromPostcode",
        "description": "Please select From Postcode."
      }
    ]
  }
}
```


(Note: The sender postcode was missing)

## Sample Response (500 – Error)


```
{
  "responseCode": "500",
  "msg": "Internal Server Error",
  "data": null
}
```


(Note: API was offline)

# Trouble Shooting

This section highlights the possible causes of API errors and possible solutions for them.

Further assistance can be obtained by sending an email to the below addresses:

Email apisupport@couriersplease.com.au or connect@couriersplease.com.au

## Possible causes of errors.

Below is a table of errors and possible causes. The following page has a list of possible solutions.

| Error Code | Value | Possible Causes |
|---|---|---|
| **400** | Bad Request | Suburb or postcode is missing.<br>Decimal Points in dimensions fields.<br>Other invalid data. |
| **401** | Unauthorised | Using Test credentials in Production environment.<br>Using Production credentials in Test environment.<br>Incorrect Account Number or API Key.<br>Incorrect Authentication Type. |
| **403** | Forbidden | Invalid character (example: /) in request.<br>Incomplete request.<br>Incorrect request structure.<br>Requesting Server Address may be blocked |
| **404** | Not found | No Rates found for Origin to Destination.<br>Total number of items exceeds 10.<br>Spelling error in suburb name.<br>postcode does not match suburb. |
| **408** | Request Timeout | API is not responding (various reasons).<br>Too many requests being passed at the same time. |
| **500** | Internal Server Error | Server may be offline |

## Possible Solutions to Errors

The table below contains to most common solutions to API errors.

| Error Code | Value | Possible Solutions |
|---|---|---|
| **400** | Bad Request | Check request for errors such as empty fields and decimal points. |
| **401** | Unauthorised | Check the credentials being used are correct<br>Contact Couriers Please to confirm credentials |
| **403** | Forbidden | Check request for errors such as invalid characters.<br>Check hosting server is not in a blacklisted country. |
| **404** | Not found | Validate suburbs and postcodes against the Location Master Table located in the "resources" menu on the Couriers Please website.<br>Validate suburbs and postcodes using the “Location” API.<br>Check that Total Quantity is not greater than 10. |
| **408** | Request Timeout | Test using a single request to see if API is online<br>Check with Couriers Please API Support. |
| **500** | Internal Server Error | Check API parameters are correct.<br>Check availability of service with Couriers Please |